



कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन
(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)
EMPLOYEES' PROVIDENT FUND ORGANISATION
(Ministry of Labour & Employment, Govt. of India)
मुख्य कार्यालय / Head Office
भविष्य निधि भवन, 14-भीकाजी कामा प्लेस, नई दिल्ली-110 066.
Bhavishya Nidhi Bhawan, 14, Bhikaiji Cama Place, New Delhi - 110 066.

No. CSD-I/Visit note/RO, Delhi-SRO ,Rohtak /2014

Dated: 05.06.2014

- 9 JUN 2014

To

1. All Addl. Central P.F. Commissioners (Zones)
2. RPFCs (In- charge) of Regional Offices
3. OICs of Sub Regional Offices

Sub: Issues related to Customer Service - Reg.

Sir,

On review of the grievance redressal position of the Organisation, it has been observed that while there has been improvement in the rate of grievance redressal of various categories, there is still a lot left to achieve in the area of customer satisfaction and totally eradicate any sense of resentment which may arise in the minds of our members, who have very high expectations from us.

It is therefore, imperative to use available mechanisms to control and reduce the level of members' grievances in order to ensure that our subscribers/members continue to repose faith and trust in our organization.

A review of functioning of grievance handling mechanisms in some field offices has revealed that due to avoidable delays and inactions ,grievances have unnecessarily cropped up and remedial measures now need to be taken.

Instructions have been issued by Head Office from time to time regarding the procedure for receipt of claims, their scrutiny and disposal. However, all field office are instructed to pay special attention to the following issues in their respective offices:-

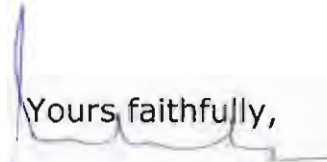
- ❖ All claims received either by hand or by post in the offices, should be entered in the system without any delay.
- ❖ In some cases, delay has been noticed in receiving back claim forms, which are referred to the Enforcement Officer, for some clarifications/wanting documents etc. This delay should be avoided.

Offices should sensitise the employers under their respective jurisdiction to comply with the provisions of Para 72(5) of the EPF Scheme, 1952, wherein the Employer is duty bound to forward duly filled in and attested claim application to the respective EPF office within five days of its receipt. Circular no. CSD-I/ACC(CSD)/Secy./2013/11729 dated 10.12.2013 in this regard may be referred.

- ❖ It is observed that often claims are returned/ rejected on minor or flimsy grounds. Objections in piecemeal should be avoided. In cases of Return/Rejection at the level of Accounts Group, proper reasons for rejection should be selected in the application software and the general practice of choosing "Other" option as the reason should be avoided, except in exceptional cases. The letter for return/rejection of claim should be generated from the system.
- ❖ Each Office should identify large Establishments submitting claims in bulk and conduct meetings/workshops, where representatives of these establishments dealing with EPFO related matters should be invited for discussion. They should be guided about the proper procedure for filling and filing of various types of claim forms, so that claims complete in all respect as per the eligibility of the member is received. The common reason/s for return/rejection should also be discussed to minimize return/rejection ratio.
- ❖ Seminars, Workshops and Training programmes should also be conducted by field offices for educating employers and members in consultation with Trade Unions and Employers' Association to advise them on the benefits available under the Schemes, claim filing and latest initiatives of EPFO.
- ❖ Special efforts should be taken to identify such establishments where difficulty in claim settlements is encountered due to improper maintenance and submission of records by the establishments. In such cases apart from advising and educating the concerned officer/officials of all such establishments on the need and importance of filing records and information in time, the practice of properly updating the records should be well monitored and followed up and compliance provisions of the Act and Scheme be enforced wherever necessary.
- ❖ Establishment master should be cleaned-up and be completed in all respect.
- ❖ All un-encashed and/or time barred cheques should be cancelled and amounts be re-credited by following due procedure, prescribed for this purpose.
- ❖ Efforts should be made to trace all such cases where member has failed to receive his claim settlement amount, where remittance has been made through NEFT mode for various reasons, such as wrong IFSC code, technical error, wrong bank account no., closed bank account etc. Further action for re-authorisation of such payments as per prescribed procedure should be taken without delay.

- ❖ Migration of past data in respect of all unreleased establishments should be effected as soon as possible.
- ❖ In cases of non-settlement of claims due to non-availability of records, especially in closed establishments, efforts should be made to use the compliance machinery in the field offices to collect wanting returns/records.
- ❖ Various cases of delay in release of monthly pension due to non receipt of Life-certificates (though submitted at Bank or office-counter) have been noticed. Pensioners should be intimated about non-receipt of Life Certificates through letters. Regular meetings should be held with the banks in this regard .
- ❖ Delay in some cases of settlement of Form-10D, where pension is required to be disbursed under other office, have been noticed. Approved IDS alongwith all required papers should be forwarded to the correct office to avoid delay in issuance of PPOs.
- ❖ All steps required to be taken in updation of accounts should be completed while issuing annual accounts so that member can view latest balance and generate e-pass book.
- ❖ There should not be any delay in issuance of Certificates of Coverage in respect of International Workers, so that grievances in this regard can be minimized.
- ❖ All grievances of the members should be properly registered on the EPFiGMS system with all details of the member (viz. contact address, email id, mobile number etc.) fed in EPFiGMS for generation of grievance registration number. Detailed instructions in this regard issued vide circular no. CSD-I/EPFiGMS/2014/2952 dated 05.05.2014 may be referred. Instructions on responsibility mapping and streamlining grievance system should be followed.

(This issues with the approval of the Central Provident Fund Commissioner.)

Yours faithfully,

(S.K. AGGARWAL)
ACC (CSD)